
ARTICLES

Building and Valuing Global Brands in the Nonprofit Sector

Nathalie Laidler-Kylander,
John A. Quelch, Bernard L. Simonin

Global nonprofit brands are the world's new "super brands" (Wootliff and Deri, 2001). Nonprofit organizations command unprecedented levels of trust, and nonprofit brand valuations are on par with major international corporations. Leaders and managers of nonprofits face new challenges in the stewardship of their brands. Based on current thinking in nonprofit management and detailed interviews with close to one hundred executives of ten international nonprofit organizations, this article draws strategic lessons on brand building and brand valuation activities of international nonprofits. The multiple roles and stakeholders that global nonprofit brands must address make nonprofit brand building complex and challenging. In particular, differences between advocacy and relief organizations must be explained. Despite the complexity, international nonprofit organizations may have an advantage over for-profits in leveraging public trust and brand communication. Advocacy organizations in particular successfully link brand and cause to good effect. The valuation of nonprofit brands is a new strategic challenge with significant appeal, but also significant concerns for international nonprofits. In addition to providing nonprofit leaders and managers with a better understanding of brand-building activities, imperatives, and best practices in the field, this article outlines the opportunities and threats associated with the valuation of nonprofit brands.

THE WORLD OF NONPROFIT leaders and managers has changed substantially over the past decades. The number of international nongovernmental organizations (NGOs) has skyrocketed, fostering intense competition. Around 25 percent of the thirteen thousand international NGOs in existence today were created

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after 1990, and overall the number of international NGOs increased by 19.3 percent between 1990 and 2000 (Eizenstat, 2004). New forms of nonprofit organizations have emerged, and new technological and communication capabilities have revolutionized the way nonprofits interact with their publics (Andreasen and Kotler, 2002). The forces of globalization have caused many nonprofit organizations to become more international, and partnerships and alliances of all types in increasing numbers have opened new frontiers and created new challenges (Austin, 2000a). Concurrently, the roles of national governments and the private sector have changed, as have the nature of philanthropy, social needs, and complex emergencies (Lindenberg and Bryant, 2001). This changing landscape has profoundly altered the mind-set and duties of nonprofit managers and leaders, propelling them into new competitive arenas where astute brand stewardship can be a differential advantage.

Global nonprofit brands command a high level of consumer trust. Global brands are defined by Aaker and Joachimsthaler (1999) as brands whose positioning, advertising strategy, personality, look, and feel are in most respects the same from one country to another. Edelman Public Relations conducts an annual study that asks respondents to rate, on a nine-point scale, the degree to which they trust a series of companies and organizations. In January 2004, the study found that global nonprofit brands ranked remarkably high on brand trust. In the United States, Amnesty International ranked as the thirteenth most trusted brand, coming in at 55 percent, behind companies such as UPS at 81 percent, Johnson & Johnson at 75 percent, and Procter & Gamble at 70 percent. Equally important perhaps, Amnesty's brand trust increased from 36 percent in 2001 to 55 percent in 2004. In Europe, global nonprofit brand trust is even greater, with the Amnesty International brand coming in top place with 63 percent and the World Wildlife Fund coming in fourth place, just behind Michelin and Microsoft at 59 percent and 57 percent, respectively. Although the Edelman studies measure only brand trust, brand value and trust are closely linked. James Burke, former CEO of Johnson & Johnson, famously stated that "the value of a brand is the value of the cumulative trust it has generated." As Keller (2000) notes, a brand is a promise kept, so trust is integral to delivering brand value.

Nonprofit brands with high trust scores are therefore very valuable. Wootliff and Deri (2001) further argue that "NGOs are no longer perceived as small bands of activists but rather as the new super brands" (p. 158). The relevance and visibility of major nonprofit organizations have blossomed, and their brands have gained in both trust and value. However, we still know relatively little about how these brands are managed and valued. For example, do international nonprofit organizations build their brands differently than international for-profits? And what benefits can international nonprofits leverage from building high brand value?

The growing interest in branding has captured the attention of nonprofit leaders. A recent survey of nonprofit organizations in Illinois revealed that enhancing the visibility and reputation of the organization was a major challenge for 80 percent of nonprofits (Grønbjerg and Child, 2003). We hope that this article can shed some additional light on the strategic role and relevance of brands for international nonprofits and help nonprofit leaders and managers in their understanding of brand-building activities and best practices in the field.

Research Context and Approach

Although there is much excitement and interest in nonprofit branding, we found little research to explain the high brand trust levels and values that Edelman described. We could find few publications that determine if and how nonprofit brand building differs from for-profit brand building (Richie, Swami, and Weinberg, 1999) and no research on the subject of nonprofit brand values and their potential role. Much of the literature on nonprofit branding stresses the importance of the brand for a nonprofit organization and adopts brand-building strategies directly from the for-profit world. To date, few field-based studies have looked at nonprofit brands in depth to answer some of the questions we have outlined.

Case study research has been found to be an effective methodology when there exists a paucity of knowledge and theory and when the phenomenon to be studied is broad and complex (Bonoma, 1985). In addition, case studies, as a research methodology, have proved useful for generating both theoretical and practical insights (Austin, 2000b). Therefore, we selected ten case studies of international nonprofit organizations engaged in development, relief, or advocacy work. These case studies reflect a variety of social purpose, activities, country of origin, and stages of global branding (see Table 1). Of the organizations studied, only BRAC was not international in scope. In terms of brand visibility and awareness, BRAC, ACCION, and Peacewinds were at the time of the study not well known by the general public. The remaining organizations were fully international, had strong brand awareness, and could be categorized as global brands (Aaker and Joachimsthaler, 1999).

Over two years, we conducted several waves of in-depth interviews with these organizations' CEOs and general managers, country managers and field directors, and headquarters staff and field personnel. Based on our probing of nearly one hundred key informants and access to supplemental material from these ten organizations and secondary sources, we completed a set of detailed case studies (Quelch and Laidler-Kylander, 2005). Our research focus was to deepen our understanding in five related areas: (1) the prerequisites to building successful nonprofit brands, (2) the comparison between nonprofit and for-profit brand building, (3) the conundrum of brand valuation, (4) implications for brand stewardship of a relief and

Table 1. Case Study Organizations

<i>Organization</i>	<i>Number of Interviews^a</i>	<i>Time Line</i>	<i>Main Issue</i>
ACCION International	Eight	October–November 2002	Brand evolution and awareness
Amnesty International	Six	January–February 2003	Brand management and leadership
BRAC	Sixteen	March 2003	Creating and sustaining the growing brand
CARE USA	Five	October–November 2002	Rebranding for alignment
Habitat for Humanity International	Six	October–November 2003	Brand valuation
International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies	Twelve	November–December 2003	Protecting the brand
Médecins Sans Frontières	Five	September–October 2003	The brand as the organizational glue
Peacewinds	Six	December–February 2003	Expanding internationally
Unicef	Twelve	September–October 2002	Rebranding for organizational change
World Wildlife Fund	Eight	September–October 2002	Leveraging the brand

^aInterviews were conducted with the CEO or general manager, country managers and field directors, and headquarters staff and field personnel.

development or an advocacy focus, and (5) the “global” meaning of global nonprofit brands.

This article reflects the efforts of a first stage of research into the field of nonprofit branding and focuses on the stages of description, classification, and, to a limited extent, theory building, as defined by Bonoma (1985). The following sections address each of the areas we have highlighted and seek to weave together a synthesis of current thinking on nonprofit branding and practical insights gained from the case studies.

Building Successful Nonprofit Brands

Among the top three skills identified as critical for future nonprofit leaders is the ability to “build your organization’s brand” (Brunham, 2002, p. 34). Other authors add that brands are vital internal instruments for galvanizing nonprofit organizations and that the most important advantage a nonprofit has is its brand, defined as a name, symbol, logo, personality, or promise that immediately tells the community and the world who you are (Birkin, 2003; Bosc, 2002).

According to Aaker (1996), the keys to successful brand building are to understand how to develop a brand identity, to know what the brand stands for, and to express that identity effectively.

The following sections integrate these existing brand-building concepts with additional insights from the field.

Developing the Brand Identity

Developing a brand identity requires both the creation of a brand meaning and the development of a clear brand positioning. Creating brand meaning involves three sequential phases of consumer communications. The first phase requires communicating to the consumer a definition of the function, quality, and roots of the brand. The second phase communicates who the users are and the use of the brand. The third phase associates enduring values with the brand in order to create emotional connections. Amnesty International, for example, successfully defined its core function as acting on behalf of and for prisoners of conscience. The organization's prospective members were people not just concerned about this issue; they were willing to take concrete action through letter-writing campaigns. The result was a brand with clear values and strong emotional connections with its membership base.

Developing a clear brand position also involves specifying three components: a target market, a superiority claim, and a reason why. For Unicef, the brand positioning is, "For people who want to make a difference, Unicef is the champion of rights for all the world's children, with the knowledge, certainty, and resources to get things done." Although this positioning statement identifies the target market segment and superiority claim, it does not perhaps provide that compelling a reason "why."

When positioning an organization, it is useful to think about the importance of a brand's benefits in driving consumers' choice, and the organization's ability to differentiate itself relative to the competition. Table 2 depicts these two dimensions, and we argue that an organization should strive to position its brand in the top left quadrant, the "jugular" benefits quadrant. (For a discussion of benefit positioning, see Kotler, 2003.) Here the benefits offered by the brand are both important to consumer choice and differentiate the organization clearly from the competition. The other quadrants all imply substantially weaker brand positions.

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Table 2. Position Against Jugular Benefits

	<i>Importance</i>	
	<i>Very Important to Choice</i>	<i>Not Very Important to Choice</i>
<i>Differentiation</i>		
Differ significantly among alternatives	Jugular benefits	Fringe benefits
Do not differ significantly among alternatives	Defensive benefits	Irrelevant benefits

Brand identity is the perception an organization seeks to create. Identity often differs from brand image, which is the existing perception of the brand in the minds of consumers or other stakeholders. Any gap between brand perception and reality may require rebranding or brand revitalization efforts (Arnold, 1992). Brands do age, and perceptions of an organization are not always in line with the organization's current activities. Therefore, attention to brand identity and brand image and the difference between the two can help guide brand-building efforts. Many executives we interviewed expressed some concern about what they perceived as discrepancies between their external brand images and desired brand identities. For two of the organizations, CARE and Unicef, this led to multiyear, in-depth rebranding efforts. For ACCION, BRAC, and, to a lesser extent, Amnesty International, branding was not a recognized organizational activity. As an executive at Amnesty International confided, "We don't actively manage our brand."

Revitalizing the Brand

Developing a revised brand identity can be a long and complex process requiring input from many stakeholders. Much like strategic planning, the process of modifying a brand identity can be of tremendous value to an organization. Brand identity flows from the organization's mission, analysis of customers and their needs, and recognition of the organization's strengths, weaknesses, and core characteristics. Sometimes the branding exercise itself can give clarity to a nonprofit's mission. Different approaches can be used to create a new brand identity. A brand footprint can be elaborated to characterize the brand in terms of human characteristics, such as visionary or dynamic, and the core values it espouses. A brand essence can capture the form, personality, differentiation, and source of authority of a brand (Aaker and Joachimsthaler, 2000), and a brand model can combine the internal vision for the brand and the external needs of the brand's customers. The older, more established nonprofit organizations in our study seemed to have looked into their brand identities to a greater extent than the newer organizations. CARE, Unicef, Habitat for Humanity International, the International Federation of the Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, and the World Wildlife Fund had all used brand footprints, brand essences, or brand models at some point in their brand analyses.

Expressing the Brand

Communicating a brand identity requires translating the brand identity to a tagline and logo, or modifying these to reflect the new brand identity. This is often the most controversial and politically difficult aspect of branding. In 2001, CARE developed an entire new brand identity, logo, and colors following a two-step rebranding process. Communicating the new brand proved to be challenging.

Sometimes the branding exercise itself can give clarity to a nonprofit's mission.

In CARE's direct-mail fundraising strategy, management was torn between keeping the old well-known logo and tagline to ensure adequate financial returns, or using the new brand that they knew would result in a lower rate of fundraising. CARE's management decided that they needed to invest in the new brand and work to attract the new pool of donors that had been identified in the development of their new brand identity. CARE's approach was therefore to "brand-raise" with the direct-mail effort: fundraise and at the same time raise brand awareness.

Protecting the Brand

Protecting a brand is a key part of brand management. Strong brands are built slowly, with substantial investments in time, money, and energy. However, a brand can be easily destroyed, and nonprofit brands, which rely heavily on trust, are particularly vulnerable. The negative impacts of scandals and criticisms, association with undesirable corporations, or simply the dilution of the brand through too many partnerships or the use of different logos and taglines throughout the world can weaken a brand and substantially reduce its value. The publicity surrounding the misuse of funds by the American Red Cross following the attacks of September 11, 2001, for example, had a negative impact on the fundraising ability of other Red Cross societies around the world. The broad and sometimes haphazard use of the World Wildlife Fund panda logo on everything from clothing to fresh bread has diluted this brand somewhat. However, only two organizations in the study—Unicef and the International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies—indicated any real concern with brand protection issues. This finding was surprising given the importance of brand protection in the literature and the role of many of these brands in fundraising. One possibility is that the majority of the organizations studied had little conscious awareness of the implications of brand dilution and erosion.

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Three Key Roles of Nonprofit Brands

In addition to the general brand-building activities, some specific features and characteristics of nonprofit organizations directly influence brand building.

The first key role of a brand is to reflect the mission of the nonprofit organization. Nonprofits are mission-driven organizations that lack the common objective shared by for-profit companies. For a nonprofit organization, the mission is its very reason for existence. Oster (1995) argues that although both for-profits and nonprofits manage their organizations on the basis of mission, the role of the mission for a nonprofit is substantially more important. The mission not only creates trust among clients and donors and helps define organizational boundaries and motivate staff; it also helps in performance evaluations.

Bosc (2002) suggests that “a powerful brand that portrays the mission can increase funding, public awareness, consumer confidence, and donor support. In addition, it can unite an organization’s employees and supporters around your mission and goals” (p. 29). Successful global nonprofit brands capture and communicate the mission clearly. As an organization’s mission evolves, its brand identity and brand image must be revitalized to reflect these mission changes. Our research supports the central role mission plays for nonprofit organizations. Indeed, all the organizations studied emphasized the critical nature of their missions—both for the organizations themselves and for defining their brands.

The second key role of a nonprofit brand is to build trust. In many nonprofits, there is a disconnect between the purchaser and the user of the organization’s product or services. In for-profit organizations, the purchaser and the user of the product are often the same. Sometimes family members and friends may influence the purchase decision, but a direct feedback loop also exists between the purchaser and the company. If the customer experience is positive, sales and market share are likely to increase, resulting in a positive financial reward for the company.

For many nonprofits, however, purchasers are individual and institutional donors, and users are the recipients of the goods or services that the nonprofit provides. Although users may choose not to accept the goods or services or may be required to pay a token fee for services, the relationship between the recipient and the nonprofit organization is not a market-based transaction. Rarely does a direct feedback loop exist to help the purchaser gauge the organization’s success or the merit of its products and services. Instead, purchasers must rely on their trust in the nonprofit’s ability to carry out its mission successfully. They cannot, as is the case with for-profits, rely on firsthand experience in order to decide whether to repeat their purchase and continue funding the nonprofit’s operations. Donor trust is therefore critical, and “brands facilitate the development of trust between a nonprofit and its constituencies” (Richie, Swami, and Weinberg, 1999, p. 2).

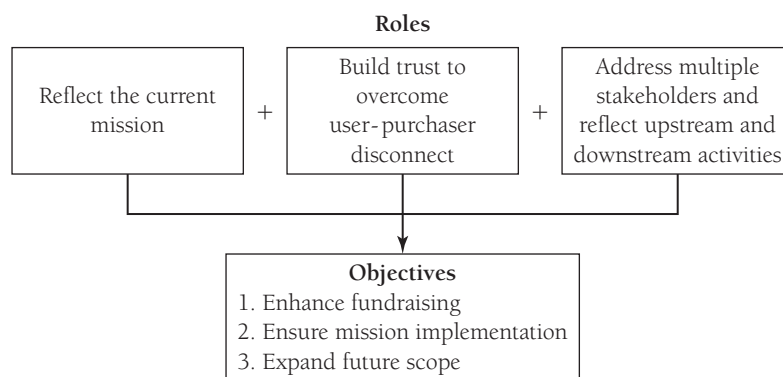
Finally, a nonprofit brand must address multiple stakeholders. Some observers believe that nonprofit organizations are more complex to manage than for-profits (Letts, Ryan, and Grossman, 1998). Much of this complexity stems from a nonprofit’s broader spectrum of stakeholders and brand audiences. A nonprofit brand must address at least six stakeholder groups: individual donors, institutional donors, employees, volunteers, beneficiaries, and potential partners. In addition, nonprofits can be viewed as having upstream activities focused on fundraising and downstream activities focused on program implementation. A single brand must encompass both sets of activities and address their corresponding stakeholders.

Top management at Médecins Sans Frontières (Doctors Without Borders) acknowledges that the brand is crucial in fundraising, where more than 80 percent of funds are derived from individual donors. Recognition of the brand enables the organization to implement its mission while ensuring the safety of its volunteers in the field and providing the credibility necessary to bear witness and provide emergency medical relief. Médecins Sans Frontières is an international organization composed of autonomous country sections, where volunteers and staff serve for only a few years. Our interviews suggest that the Médecins Sans Frontières brand, itself a reflection of the organization's mission, provides the backbone for organizational continuity and culture and that the shared Médecins Sans Frontières brand acts as a form of glue, binding together the country sections. Seven of the ten organizations in our study recognized to some extent the multiple roles their brands play. ACCION, BRAC, and Amnesty International seemed to have spent less time thinking about the role of their brands. For ACCION, consumer fundraising had traditionally been less of an issue and the organization was well respected within the microfinance community in which it operated. BRAC's modest approach of "letting our actions speak for themselves" contrasted with the promotional emphasis and global branding approach of the key competitor, Grameen Bank, despite the fact that it could have leveraged what in Bangladesh is a household name.

As summarized in Figure 1, a nonprofit brand must reflect the current mission of the organization, build trust with consumers, and address multiple stakeholders by reflecting both upstream and downstream activities. The brand must also be flexible enough to embrace three evolving objectives: enhancing fundraising, ensuring the implementation of the organization's mission, and expanding the future scope of the organization.

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Figure 1. Roles and Objectives of Global Nonprofit Brands



Similarities and Differences Between Nonprofit and For-Profit Brand Building

Many similarities exist between nonprofits and for-profits in terms of the components and challenges of building strong brands. Both face intensive competition for share of mind, share of wallet, and share of heart. Brand competition is increasingly a reality for nonprofits. As their traditional sources of government funding diminish, they are turning to individual donors to ensure greater independence and are thereby becoming more credible advocates.

For both nonprofits and for-profits, fundamental organizational values drive the brand essence and positioning and form the basis of brand communications. Simple brand names, the global consistency of the brand presentation across multiple markets and geographies, and the use of a single brand as opposed to multiple brand names are characteristics of a strong brand-focused organization in both the nonprofit and for-profit arenas. As Murley (2004) suggests, the “right name opens doors, invites people in, and sets the stage for the marketing process to begin” (p. 21). He argues that the brand is the “single most important marketing decision you can make” (p. 21). As organizations and their environments change, brands need to be revitalized so that brand image, or perception in the market, is more closely aligned with brand identity, itself an aspirational reflection of the organization. This holds true for both nonprofits and for-profits.

Both nonprofit and for-profit organizations have seen an increase in the use of brand alliances and co-marketing programs (Wymer and Samu, 2003). Negotiating such arrangements requires knowledge of a brand’s financial value and is equally important for nonprofit and for-profit organizations, as we shall see in subsequent sections of this article. Half of the ten organizations studied were engaged in brand alliances with the private sector. The World Wildlife Fund, in particular, had developed detailed partnership guidelines and objectives and allocated substantial resources to the management of these partnerships. Unicef, Habitat for Humanity International, the International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, and CARE also engaged in multiple partnerships with for-profit corporations. BRAC had perhaps gone one step further by developing its own commercial businesses and brand.

A major difference between nonprofit and for-profit brand building stems from the importance of the mission. International nonprofits are mission driven, but they often have broad or lofty missions that can make brand positioning difficult. A mission defined too narrowly runs the risk of being insufficiently engaging and motivating. A mission defined too broadly, however, can encourage mission creep (an unintended extension of the mission) and an unclear brand position, which could result in brand dilution and confusion. As Allen Grossman, former CEO of Outward Bound, notes, “The difficulty is often deciding who not to serve with the

mission. Often, brand dilution comes from adopting multiple beneficiaries.” Consistency between mission and message is of great importance for nonprofits. Baker (2004) notes: “The best nonprofit brands today are built on two things. First, doing excellent and trustworthy work, and second, presenting the same single consistent message over many years.”

Given the complex stakeholder mix and the multiple roles that a global nonprofit brand must play, brand management of nonprofits runs the risk of trying to be all things to all people, which undermines the potential for brand clarity and consistency. The use of acronyms rather than descriptive names is one approach used frequently to add flexibility to a brand’s positioning. Despite the fact that the vast majority of nonprofits rely on acronyms rather than their full names, Murley (2004) believes that “using acronyms is rarely a good marketing ploy” (p. 21). He notes that “over 90% of nonprofit organizations introduce themselves on their Web sites by their acronyms” and believes that this is a mistake. “For most nonprofits,” he adds, “it makes no sense to reinforce an acronym that holds no meaning for potential audiences. The acronym alone doesn’t communicate a market position” (p. 21). Three of the organizations studied—World Wildlife Fund (WWF), the International Federation of the Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC), and Médecins Sans Frontières (MSF)—routinely used these acronyms rather than their full names. For three others (BRAC, CARE, and Unicef) the acronyms had essentially replaced the organizations’ original names. For Amnesty International (AI), the name and acronym were used interchangeably, but Habitat for Humanity International (HFHI) used the acronym only internally. Only Peacewinds and ACCION International did not use an acronym.

Compared to many international for-profit companies, international nonprofit organizations have highly decentralized organizational structures with little or low control by headquarters. This, coupled with little formal hierarchy and a consensus-building culture valued by many individuals choosing to work for nonprofit organizations, makes the implementation of a single strong global brand identity particularly challenging. In our case studies on CARE and Unicef, the implementation of a rebranding initiative proved to be a highly contentious and multiyear endeavor. Any attempt to modify the brand logo in particular triggered an outpouring of pent-up concerns about the nonprofit’s mission, values, and resource allocation.

Many international nonprofit organizations profess resistance to and skepticism of so-called commercial techniques, including brand building and advertising. Nonprofit leaders and managers sometimes question the cost-benefit of investing in brand-building activities, particularly when this might direct funds from programs to reach beneficiaries.

Although both nonprofit and for-profit brands use media and celebrity endorsements, some nonprofits, particularly advocacy

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organizations such as Amnesty International, have successfully linked their brand with a specific cause. These organizations, whose very mission is to advocate and communicate on specific issues, may have an inherent advantage over development and relief organizations and for-profit companies in brand positioning and brand communication. Advocacy organizations are both focused and relentless in their communications, whereas humanitarian organizations tend to kick in when there is a crisis requiring a public donor response.

Trust is critical for nonprofits and may give their brands a head start in building their brand images with the general public. The lack of stock ownership means that the managers of nonprofits have no reason not to do the right thing, resulting in greater public trust. The lack of stock ownership, however, has also been blamed for the inadequacy of incentives for many nonprofit managers to be efficient (Speckbacher, 2003).

Many brand-building fundamentals apply equally to both nonprofits and for-profits, but nurturing a strong global nonprofit brand requires patience, consensus building, and the ability to manage a greater degree of complexity. Table 3 highlights the similarities and differences between nonprofits and for-profits in brand building.

Table 3. Brand-Building Similarities and Differences Between Nonprofits and For-Profits

<i>Similarities</i>	<i>Differences</i>
High levels of brand competition	Broad mission in nonprofits risks brand dilution and confusion
Brand values help guide the development of a brand essence, which flows into brand positioning and communication	Complex stakeholder mix and multiple brand roles suggest that the nonprofit brand must be multifaceted, yet internally consistent
Simple brand names work best	The decentralized, consensus-building culture of nonprofits can make brand implementation harder
Global marketing consistency is key	Resistance to and skepticism of investing in brand-building activities
Power of single brands	Ability to link brand and cause to provide brand communication advantages
Rise of brand alliances and partnerships	Nonprofits operate in trust markets, giving their brands a head start
Need for brand revitalization	
Importance of brand valuation	

Brand Building and Brand Valuation

Brand valuation is the determination of the financial worth of an organization's brand as an intangible asset. Initially used in the 1980s to help with ascertaining a company's value for merger and acquisition negotiations, "the value of acquired brands can now be put on the balance sheets of acquiring companies in the UK, France, Australia, New Zealand and to a lesser extent, companies in the U.S.A." (Lindemann, 2004, pp. 30–31).

More recently, brand valuation has been applied to a number of major nonprofit brands such as the United Way, the American Cancer Society, and PBS. This focus on nonprofit brand valuation, and the surprisingly high resulting valuations, have increased attention to the brand-building efforts of major nonprofit organizations. Although several of the organizations we studied expressed interest in brand valuation, at the time of the study only one organization, Habitat for Humanity International, had conducted a full brand valuation. This valuation, conducted by Interbrand, had resulted in a brand value estimate in 2001 of \$1.8 billion, the same valuation at the time as Starbucks Coffee (Quelch, Austin, and Laidler-Kylander, 2004).

A number of different brand valuation approaches for companies exist, but the most widely used ones are based on a prediction of the future cash flows generated by, and directly attributable to, a specific brand. Interbrand has modified this approach to develop a methodology for the valuation of nonprofit brands based on the future value of funds raised less expenses, discounted to reflect brand strength (Doyle, 2000). Specifically, revenues, including cash and in-kind donations, are forecast for the future (typically for five or ten years out). The administrative costs associated with raising the funds and managing the programs are deducted, resulting in the funds that "pass through to beneficiaries." The percentage of these pass-through funds that are attributable to the brand, based on the extent to which different business drivers are dependent on the brand, is then calculated. Finally, a discount rate reflective of brand strength and based on seven specific criteria developed by Interbrand is applied to the projected flows attributable to the brand to arrive at a current brand value. These seven criteria are market (growth), stability (customer loyalty), leadership (market share), internationality (worldwide appeal), trend (consistent growth), support (consistent marketing support), and protection (trademarks).

A nonprofit can benefit from knowing the value of its brand by extracting greater value from corporate partners, creating alliances, and advocating with confidence. In the case of Habitat for Humanity International, the high value of the brand came as a surprise that both increased management commitment to building equity for the brand and improved partner quality, exclusivity, and continuity.

Although many nonprofit leaders believe that people are their organization's most valuable asset, we would argue that for many international nonprofits, their brand is the most valuable asset they possess.

Other benefits of undergoing a brand valuation include increased respect and resources for brand-building activities as well as the ability to require greater brand logo and slogan discipline throughout the international organization. The brand valuation process itself highlights key brand value drivers, enabling a nonprofit to focus future brand-building efforts by providing information about a specific brand's strengths and weaknesses. Regular and successive brand valuations can serve to monitor and measure the impact of marketing and brand-building activities over time. Brands with high values can help attract employees and increase employee pride and retention, as well as donor and volunteer motivation. Although many nonprofit leaders believe that people are their organization's most valuable asset, we would argue that for many international nonprofits, their brand is the most valuable asset they possess. Knowledge of this value can help create leverage with policymakers, but also places extra responsibility on the nonprofit CEO as brand steward.

We also believe that in the future, brands will commonly be valued and carried on the balance sheets of nonprofit organizations in the United States, as suggested by Lindemann (2004). In this case, the intangible asset that the brand represents could be used as collateral for loans. Brand value rankings are common in the for-profit sector and generate considerable interest and excitement. Brand value rankings for nonprofits would be one way to compare and grade disparate nonprofit organizations where comparables such as profitability and share price do not currently exist.

Public knowledge of a high nonprofit brand value, however, could result in donor and volunteer demotivation. Small donors might no longer believe that their contributions are either needed or likely to make a difference. This, we were told, was the main reason that the American Cancer Society does not disclose Interbrand's assessment of the value of its brand. Some are concerned that using a high brand value to exploit corporate partnerships may increase a nonprofit's dependency on corporate funding, at the expense of individual donors. Others worry that an "obsession" with brand value will distract a nonprofit from its mission and issues of mission linkage. Mason (1992), for example, is concerned that "such activities may commercialize nonprofits and divert their energies from their primary mission" (p. 30).

Brand valuation for nonprofits is a reality and will continue to gain momentum as the seduction of a single financial number by which nonprofits can be ranked takes hold. However, many concerns and outstanding questions exist. The linkages between brand trust, specific brand-building activities, and brand value require further research. The possibility of behavior that does not further the mission stemming from a focus on brand and brand values is a valid concern. Finally, in transferring brand valuation techniques from the

for-profit world, we need to determine which aspects of the existing method are appropriate and which are not. It appears that new brand valuation models are needed for nonprofit organizations.

Many concerns exist with both the Interbrand methodology for valuing nonprofit brands and the concept and use of brand valuation itself. Interbrand's current methodology does not take into account the value of volunteer time and therefore underestimates the value of a brand that attracts volunteer commitments. As a result, "Northern" NGOs might appear erroneously as even more valuable than "Southern" NGOs. In addition, measuring the percentage of revenues passed through to beneficiaries does not measure the efficiency with which nonprofits implement their missions, nor does it capture the impact or value that they provide.

Table 4 summarizes the potential benefits and possible concerns of brand valuation for nonprofit brands. The relationship between brand building and brand valuation is direct, codependent, and mutually reinforcing. Arozian (2003) argues that "branding is a way to establish a strategic perception of a nonprofit's value among a range of constituencies" (p. 9). A strong, consistent brand-building effort that results in a clear, well-positioned, and highly trusted and recognized brand will also generate a high brand valuation over time. A detailed brand valuation can reveal clear priorities and actions for future brand-building activities. Successive brand valuations can help monitor and assess brand-building efforts, thereby helping to fine-tune or validate a nonprofit's specific brand-building activities.

A detailed brand valuation can reveal clear priorities and actions for future brand-building activities.

Table 4. Potential Benefits and Concerns of Brand Valuation for Nonprofit Brands

<i>Benefits</i>	<i>Concerns</i>
Greater value from corporate partners, alliances, and policymakers	Value of volunteer time not accounted for
Increased respect and resources for brand-building activities	Brand valuation does not measure efficiency or impact
Greater logo and slogan discipline	Public knowledge of brand values may demotivate donors and volunteers
Elucidation of key brand value drivers and future brand-building activities	Increased dependency on corporate funding
Monitoring and impact measurement of brand-building activities	Maintain bias toward established Northern NGOs
Recruitment of employees, increasing employee pride and retention	Distraction from the core mission
Motivation of donors and volunteers	No single, standardized method accepted
Increase in leverage with policymakers	

Relief and Development Organizations and Advocacy Organizations: Implications for Brand Building

Our research also highlights some fundamental differences between nonprofit organizations focused on relief and those focused on advocacy. In a brainstorming session with ecumenical leaders in 2003, key characteristics and descriptors for these two types of organizations were developed (see Table 5). These fundamental differences have an important impact on the brand-building characteristics of these two groups of organizations.

Advocacy organizations such as Amnesty International and the World Wildlife Fund tend to be membership organizations, relying heavily on their own members' financial contributions through membership dues and active participation as volunteers. They prefer to be independent of government or corporate funding to ensure that they can carry out their advocacy roles objectively and credibly. Advocacy group members are the primary consumers and tend to be highly involved in their organizations, viewing their role as one of participating in a club. The decision to become a member is often planned and scheduled over time. Organizational success is measured through the ability to generate change (often political) and, increasingly, the ability to effectively network with other organizations to do so (Lindenberg and Bryant, 2001). The basis of consumer trust stems from the organization's perceived purity and impartiality as well as the worthiness of the cause and mission in the eyes of the consumer. Brands are "owned by the consumer in that they only exist in the minds of the consumers themselves" (Temporal, 2002, p. 14). For advocacy organizations in the nonprofit sector, brand ownership lies principally in the hands of its own members.

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Table 5. Key Characteristics of Relief and Development Organizations and Advocacy Organizations

<i>Relief and Development</i>	<i>Advocacy</i>
Charity	Movement
Reactive	Proactive
One-off	Sustainable
Emotional	Cerebral
Worthy	Edgy
Older	Younger
Government funds	Individual donors
Operations focused	Strategy and operations
Decentralized	Centralized
Easier to manage	Harder to manage
Easier to like and support	Higher reputation risk

Note: This table was developed with the help of participants of an executive education program for ecumenical leaders hosted by the Harvard Divinity School in June 2003.

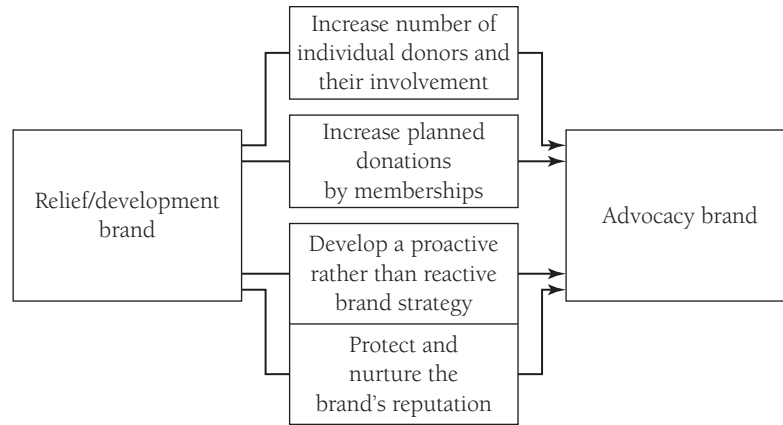
For relief and development organizations such as the International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, Médecins Sans Frontières, Unicef, and CARE, periodic donors (rather than members) are considerably less involved in the organization on a continuous basis. Their donations are infrequent and more likely to be impulse driven, often in reaction to a humanitarian crisis or advertised need. Organizational success is measured by program performance, and consumer (donor) trust depends mainly on the organization's global reputation to spend resources wisely and effectively. Brand ownership lies in the hands of both individual and institutional donors, although the role of the individual donor for most international nonprofits is increasing as institutional funding from government organizations becomes more limited. Based on the above observations drawn from our field work, Table 6 summarizes brand-building characteristics for relief and development organizations and advocacy organizations.

Many of the traditional relief and development organizations we studied have moved, or have at least started moving, into advocacy work. They need a greater fundraising focus on individual donors to ensure their independence and impartiality and will have to increase donor involvement and target clearly different donor segments. We believe that a brand that has a proactive strategy, rather than simply reacting to crisis, will have a better chance of attracting new, more involved donors. Organizational success and continued funding will require impact measures and the ability to generate sustainable change. In order to reduce financial dependence on humanitarian crises to trigger donations, a concerted effort to move donors to membership status is required. BRAC stands out as an organization attempting to gain financial independence by moving into profit-generating activities linked to its development projects. As such, it is unique in its ability to increase the effectiveness of advocacy work.

Table 6. Brand-Building Characteristics for Relief and Development Organizations and Advocacy Organizations

	<i>Relief and Development</i>	<i>Advocacy</i>
Consumer characteristics	Donor is the customer Lower involvement	Member is the customer Participation in a club Higher involvement
Donations (purchase decision)	Infrequent, impulsive	Planned, time-released
Criteria for organizational success and brand trust	Program performance Nonprofit halo Global reputation	Political performance and network Purity and impartiality
Principal brand owners	Individual and institutional donors	Members

Figure 2. Moving the Relief and Development Brand Toward an Advocacy Brand



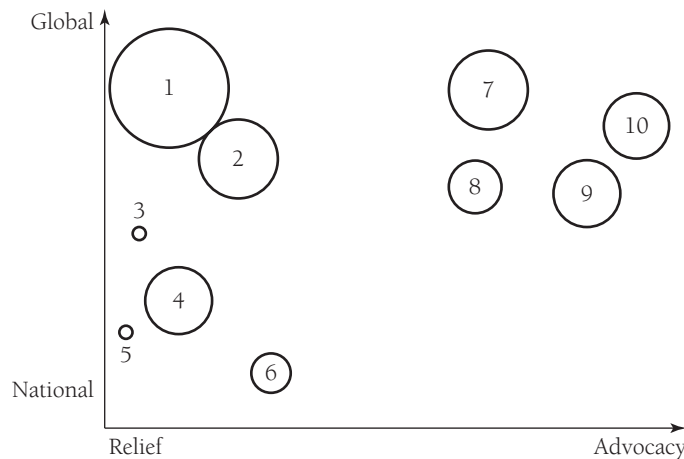
Finally, since purity and impartiality are critical to brand trust for advocacy brands, an even greater emphasis on protecting the brand's reputation is necessary. Figure 2 summarizes suggested actions for migrating relief and development brands into advocacy brands.

Global Brands

Aaker and Joachimsthaler (1999) advance four fundamental principles for effective global brand leadership in the corporate world: (1) stimulate the sharing of best practices and insights across countries, (2) support a common global brand-planning process, (3) assign managerial responsibility to generate cross-country synergies and to reduce local bias, and (4) execute brilliant brand-building strategies.

Our study endorses these criteria in the world of nonprofits. (See Figure 3 for a mapping of the case studies on a national to global scale.) The first principle, the sharing of best practices and managerial insights, falls under the more general theme of the learning organization (see Marquardt, 1996; Swieringa and Wierdsma, 1992). The learning organization requires an organizational culture that both encourages the codifying and sharing of knowledge and does not reject experimentation for fear of failure. The International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies recently implemented the National Society Self-Assessment program to monitor and provide support to its national members in achieving a set of organizational best practices defined as the "characteristics of a well-functioning national society." Self-assessment coupled with peer review by other national societies ensures that all members focus on the governance and self-monitoring standards that will strengthen and protect the movement's overall brand throughout the International

Figure 3. Case Study Organizations Mapped by Extent of Global and Advocacy Characteristics



Note: Circle size indicates relative organization size as reflected by revenues.

1, International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies; 2, CARE; 3, ACCION; 4, Habitat for Humanity International; 5, Peacewinds; 6, BRAC; 7, Unicef; 8, Médicins Sans Frontières; 9, World Wildlife Fund; 10, Amnesty International

Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies network. BRAC has been referred to as a quintessential learning organization with an organizational culture that promotes risk taking and experimentation. The organization has refined the use of pilot projects to iron out difficulties and accelerate learning, before scaling up development programs to spectacularly successful effect. Finally, the World Wildlife Fund often acts in a consulting capacity, monitoring and enhancing the environmental efforts of partner companies and sharing best practices across organizations.

Initiating and institutionalizing a common global brand-planning process, the second principle, presents a major challenge for international nonprofits, given the scope of activities and the number and location of relevant stakeholders. The first time such a planning exercise was undertaken systematically in both the CARE and Unicef organizations, it had both a traumatic and therapeutic effect. The trauma arose from realizing how complex and unfocused the overall organization had become, particularly with respect to its branding activities and positioning. Fears of change and resentment surfaced with the advent of more professional management of marketing activities. When CARE initiated its brand identity and strategy formulation program, for instance, *brand* was considered a dirty word by many in the organization. In addition to these two examples, five other organizations had started to think about global branding as an organizationwide issue and had spent time and effort attempting to harmonize their brands.

We believe that rebranding sends a strong signal about the need for cohesiveness and integration throughout the organization.

We believe that rebranding sends a strong signal about the need for cohesiveness and integration throughout the organization. It can stimulate paranoia: an anticipated and generalizable loss of autonomy by country offices and a takeover of control by headquarters. If the leadership can stay the course through this period of doubt, the process itself of launching a global brand-building program can be of great therapeutic value to the organization. It can show, often for the first time, that the organization can function as a whole, as opposed to acting like a collection of parts or competing interests; it can bring a sense of unity and self-identity to an amorphous network of country offices and affiliates; and it can set an important precedent for other organizationwide initiatives by demonstrating that the collective input is operational and worthy.

The third principle pertains to configuring global brand responsibilities. Who should be responsible for building and nurturing the brand? In practice, the simple truth is that those who run the organization are also responsible for the brand. Without a global brand strategy and a concerted effort to implement it, many of the organizations we studied showed signs of brand degeneration and dissonant positioning. When everyone (and therefore no one) owns the brand, the result is brand cacophony, if not chaos: numerous visual identities (official and unofficial), variations, stylizations, colors of texts, names, acronyms, logos, and other proprietary symbols and associations. Organizations in the study that suffered from some level of dissonance with different visual identities in different countries included CARE, Médecins Sans Frontières, Unicef, the World Wildlife Fund, and, to a lesser extent, Amnesty International and Habitat for Humanity International. As these organizations transform themselves and commit to a global brand strategy, the necessary participatory process of brand building that engages the entire worldwide organization cannot mask a new reality: the emergence of an epicenter of brand-building activities typically located in the head office of the nonprofit. The degree to which cross-country synergies can be attained and unnecessary local biases minimized rests on a fine line between coordination and power struggle between headquarters and country offices. This power struggle was encountered in three of the organizations studied (the International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, Unicef, and, to a lesser extent, Amnesty International). Head office control was substantial for Habitat for Humanity International and the World Wildlife Fund, while for CARE and Médecins Sans Frontières, we found that headquarters was intentionally weak, with country offices maintaining power.

Finally, the fourth principle, crafting inspired brand-building strategies and delivering brilliant executions, has become a key imperative for international nonprofits. Amateurish, wishful-thinking campaigns are relics of the past. Today international nonprofits operate in a highly competitive environment, facing the same communication challenges, media clutter, and overexposed, skeptical target audiences as commercial enterprises. Successful global branding calls for keen

expertise, creativity, and resourcefulness. Many of the international nonprofits we studied were able to access such scarce and valuable resources by securing pro bono services from the best marketing services in the profession. For instance, CARE benefited from the services of McCann-Erickson Worldwide, Habitat for Humanity International from the help of Interbrand, Unicef from the services of TBWA, and the International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies from the services of Young & Rubicam. Nonprofits must be skillful and imaginative in their use of the full repertoire of communication vehicles, from the use of traditional advertising media to the staging of publicity-generating events, sponsorship arrangements, use of spokespersons, and direct marketing activities, through the Internet as well as the mail. The standards of excellence in nonprofit brand leadership have gone up; today, the executions of some of these global brand-building strategies are award-winning ads and communication programs. Of the ten organizations studied, we found that seven had effectively used professional media advertising.

In their recent study on global brands, Holt, Quelch, and Taylor (2004) suggest that consumers across twelve countries pay special attention to global brands because of three main characteristics: a signal of quality, a connection to the global consumer, and a sense of social responsibility. These dimensions are equally pertinent to global nonprofit brands. Our fieldwork suggests that the globalness of the nonprofit organizations afforded them a special status, one of a reliable, scaled, and experienced human service provider (quality signal), and of a neutral, objective, dignified, and universal promise keeper (global village). While certain inefficiencies and bureaucratic traits are still associated with some large nonprofits, it is also reassuring that globalness and global reach convey benefits that can be exploited in brand-building activities. Strong global brands have a significant presence across all or most regions of the world, and a consistent brand positioning. Strong global brands address similar consumer needs worldwide, operate with the same brand and logo, and are focused on a single product category or purpose. Two common pitfalls occur when managing global brands: the urge to standardize the entire brand strategy kit worldwide and ignoring markets at different stages of development (Quelch and Hoff, 1986).

While the literature lacks consensus on performance outcomes of standardized marketing programs, recent empirical work (Ozsomer and Simonin, 2004) has shown that disentangling the effects of product-related from those of non-product-related decisions is important. Two simultaneous and opposite effects are at work: centralization of product-related decisions tends to enhance overall performance, while centralization of non-product-related decisions tends to decrease performance. Successful global brands tend to "think global, act local." They standardize the more strategic elements (brand name and positioning) and adapt the latter components (copy platform and execution) to local markets.

Of the ten organizations studied, we found that seven had effectively used professional media advertising.

Successful international nonprofits adhere to these branding principles and also understand when to adapt them. These organizations know how to push the envelope of global harmonization and efficiencies in the face of reticence and opposition from field offices, and, more important, they know when to allow customization or back off. This starts with active listening and engaging in dialogue with all stakeholders. CARE headquarters, for instance, as part of its fundamental brand overhaul, thought that the new tagline, “Where the end of poverty begins,” best captured its core mission and brand essence in a way that would inspire others to support and act on it. But at the same time, many of CARE’s European members and field staff felt strongly that the tagline lacked humility and would put off partners in the field. The ensuing debate was resolved by allowing country offices to adopt a modified, more integrative tagline: “Together, where the end of poverty begins.”

The second pitfall of global brand management, ignoring markets at different stages of development, is a matter of lack of acuity in branding strategy, one of farsightedness: globalness over readiness. Globalness without market sensitivity is a recipe for failure, as it implies an artificially common denominator solution on stakeholders lacking commonality. Barron and Hollingshead (2004) further contend that multinationals tend to struggle with global branding because of a fundamental flaw: “They attempt to analyze their *brand* from a global perspective without first analyzing their *consumers* from a global perspective” (p. 9). The underlying premise that across countries there must be consumers who share a common set of beliefs and motivations that the brand can target is rarely verified by consumer research, though clusters of consumers crossing national boundaries can sometimes be uncovered. In the world of nonprofits, the problem is compounded by significant differences in an organization’s path to internationalization, its history and presence in different countries, and varying levels of brand awareness and brand meaning. Sean Barrett, senior director of communications at Amnesty International, describes Amnesty’s brand strategy in different markets as follows: “While, in the developed countries or ‘North,’ Amnesty International is an established, well-known brand in its mid-life, in the developing world or ‘South,’ it is a very young, fairly unknown brand.” Although a globally recognized brand, Amnesty International must be managed effectively in different parts of the world. International nonprofits must tailor their branding efforts to the brand’s life-cycle stage in each region or country.

***Globalness
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Conclusion

Brands play multiple, critical roles for nonprofit organizations and speak to a variety of stakeholders. A strong brand is essential for fundraising, enabling nonprofit organizations to implement their missions successfully. By building trust with consumers and donors,

and addressing the user-purchaser disconnect, strong global brands can provide the organizational glue to bind together fragmented international nonprofit organizations.

The roles brands play and the stakeholders they address vary depending on the characteristics of the organizations themselves. Brand ownership, brand trust, and brand “purchase” characteristics differed among those organizations focused on relief and development and those focused on advocacy. Since an increasing number of nonprofit organizations are including advocacy in their key activities, it is important for nonprofit leaders and managers to understand these differences. Nonprofits excel at leveraging public trust and brand communication through free public relations and celebrity endorsements. Advocacy organizations in particular have a clear advantage over for-profits in their ability to link their brands with important social causes for maximum impact.

Brand-building activities have the potential to trigger virtuous cycles in international nonprofits. The concerted and participatory nature of a global branding initiative can successfully demonstrate, often for the first time, the desirability and viability of involving the entire network of country offices and affiliates. A frequent by-product of the effort is the creation of a sense of unity and belonging, with the organization learning how to operate on a truly global basis. The decision-making process can create a successful precedent and teach lessons for more complex or “messier” global initiatives. Although brands are intangible assets, the importance of their role for nonprofit organizations and the surprisingly high level of consumer trust that they command make them very valuable. Brand valuation presents both benefits and potential concerns; the opportunity to measure a brand’s worth and potentially rank nonprofits on this basis is seductive. For nonprofit leaders and managers, knowing the value of the brand asset can ensure that it is measured and protected, and leveraged in funds raised through corporate partnerships and in advocacy power with policymakers. As the temporary stewards of their organizations, nonprofit managers and leaders are uniquely responsible for strengthening their brand assets and for successfully positioning their organizations for the future.

NATHALIE LAIDLER-KYLANDER is a doctoral candidate at the Fletcher School, Tufts University, Medford, Massachusetts.

JOHN A. QUELCH is the Lincoln Filene Professor of Business Administration at Harvard Business School, Boston.

BERNARD L. SIMONIN is associate professor of marketing and international business at the Fletcher School, Tufts University, Medford, Massachusetts.

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